

THE FAME DENTISTRY MANIFESTO

A Note About What You Are Reading

If you're reading this, you've had a conversation with us about joining the FAME Dentistry team. I want to start with a genuine thank you for that.

What you're holding isn't a job description. It isn't a contract. And it's not a brochure designed to sell you on working here. What it is, I hope, is an honest picture of who I am, what I believe, and what kind of place FAME Dentistry is going to be.

I want you to read this and feel one of two things. Either this is the most exciting opportunity you've ever come across in dentistry or this isn't for me. Both are the right answers if they're honest. The only wrong answer is to join us and find out later that you had doubts you never voiced.

I didn't arrive at dentistry with a childhood dream. I arrived because my cultural background expected it, because my friends were doing it, and because the title of 'Doctor' mattered in ways I barely understood at seventeen. What I didn't expect was to fall in love with it.

That love came slowly – through exposure to Doctors whose excellence I wanted to replicate, through the study of medicine that sharpened my thinking about human beings and how they work, through years of understanding that when a patient sits in that chair, they

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are trusting me with something profound. They are placing their wellbeing in my hands. That is not a transaction. That is a privilege.

Everything FAME Dentistry is built on flows from that one belief. And everyone who joins this team needs to feel it too.

Dr Ferhan Ahmed
Founder, FAME Dentistry

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My Story, so Far

There is a version of my story that sounds straightforward: a dentist from Glasgow who trained hard, built a practice, and set ambitious targets. That version is true, but it misses everything that matters.

Where It Starts

My father arrived in the United Kingdom at nine years old. By fifteen, he had left school and was working sixteen hours a day, seven days a week, from six in the morning until ten at night. If there is one thing I got from him that defines me, it is his grit. I realised that early, growing up as one of five siblings. The question for me was never whether to meet the standard. It was how to exceed it.

Growing up in an Asian family, the career options weren't plentiful. You could be a doctor, an accountant, or a failure. That expectation could have felt like a trap. For me, it felt like a challenge – and I have always been someone who responds to challenges by leaning in rather than stepping back.

The Boy Behind the Counter

I was shy as a child. It is easy to forget that now, but it matters. From nine to fifteen years old, I worked in my father's shop in a working-class community on the outskirts of Glasgow. Customers would come in, notice

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the small boy behind the counter, and ask questions. What's your name? What school do you go to? What do you want to be?

I learned, gradually and then all at once, how to talk to people I didn't know. Not as a technique. As a habit. As something that became natural through repetition, through showing up, through choosing not to retreat into discomfort. That choice – to engage rather than withdraw – runs through everything I have done since.

The Contrarian

Glasgow has two football teams. The majority of people around me supported Celtic. I supported Rangers. Not to be awkward – but because it was genuinely what I felt, and I wasn't willing to pretend otherwise to make things easier.

That instinct has followed me everywhere. I chose dentistry when medicine was the more prestigious option. I went back to study medicine after dental school when all my peers were getting comfortable financially. I walked away from a near-certain career as a maxillofacial surgeon because I could feel it would mean surrendering control of my own destiny. Every one of those choices was made against the grain of what was expected – and every one was made from a place of genuine self-knowledge. You have to know what you actually think before you can hold onto it.

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The Hard Years

After completing my dental degree in Glasgow in 2005, I felt something I couldn't name – a persistent hunger that existing achievements couldn't silence. So I went back to university and studied medicine.

What followed was years of debt, night shifts, weekends on call, driving home after 4:30am starts trying to stay awake by rolling down the car window in the cold. I was behind my peers financially. I was doing something most people around me didn't understand. I kept going because my internal conviction was stronger than my external circumstances – and because I had learned, by that point, to trust it.

Then came the partnership. Seven dental practices built across Scotland in eighteen months. Within two and a half years, it was over.

That failure could have become the thing that defined me. For a while, it threatened to. But I have always believed that the only way a setback becomes a real failure is if you stop moving. So I travelled – to Brazil, to South Africa – and sought out the world's best implant dentists. I came back and built a clinical reputation that eventually saw me training other dentists nationally and internationally.

Not despite the failure. Because of what I chose to do with it.

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Knowing Yourself

The most important work I have ever done has not been clinical. It has been internal.

I started journaling. I came across a book called *Miracle Mornings* by Hal Elrod and as a result I rebuilt my mornings – getting up earlier, creating routines that put me in the right mental state before the world made the demands it makes on all of us. I discovered that the morning belongs to you if you choose to claim it, and that the person who wins the morning usually wins the day. That single insight changed the trajectory of everything.

I read. Consistently and deliberately – not as a hobby but as a practice. I pay attention to my own patterns; the routines that keep me sharp, the conditions that bring out my best, the behaviours in others that signal genuine hunger versus the performance of it. That self-awareness isn't something I was born with. It is a skill I built, over decades, by refusing to look away from myself.

Why I'm Telling You This

I am not someone who arrived. I am someone who became – through deliberate effort, repeated failure, honest self-examination, and a refusal to settle that I couldn't switch off even when it would have been easier to try.

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FAME Dentistry is not a monument to where I have got to. It is the next expression of who I am still becoming. I still get up early. I still read. I still believe that the gap between where I am and where I could be is the most interesting place to live.

The people I want around me feel the same way about their own lives.

Not perfect people. Not people who have always got it right. People who have developed the self-awareness to know the difference between where they are and where they could be – and who find that gap energising rather than dispiriting.

That is what it means to be part of this team.

What We're Building

FAME Dentistry is not a dental practice in the conventional sense. It is a business with an audacious ambition: to become the most talked-about, most recommended, most admired dental practice in the world.

Our target is an ambitious £10 million in revenue within three years of opening. Eventually we intend to be operating by referral only with patients travelling internationally to experience what we do. We expect business leaders – people who understand excellence and run exceptional organisations themselves – to visit our practice, sit in our chairs, be astonished by what

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they experience, and leave wondering how they can replicate it in their own businesses.

That last bit is important. We are not simply trying to do great dentistry. We are building a customer experience so extraordinary that it inspires the people who receive it.

Our Vision

Within three years, FAME Dentistry will claim the world's highest Net Promoter Score for dentists. We will be recognised by the wider international business community as a leader in developing business culture and customer experiences that deliver extraordinary value to all stakeholders.

The Net Promoter Score is the world's most widely used measure of customer loyalty. Businesses with the highest NPS scores – companies like Apple, Tesla, and Ritz-Carlton – don't just satisfy customers. They create advocates. They create people who can't stop talking about what happened to them.

We intend to be the only dental practice in the world that belongs in that conversation.

This isn't self-aggrandisement. It's a standard. And it only happens if every person in this team understands, believes in, and relentlessly pursues it.

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Who We Are

The name 'FAME' means something – I didn't just pluck it out of thin air or hire a fancy marketing agency to run focus groups to come up with it.

The dictionary definition:

1. the state of being known or talked about by many people, especially on account of notable achievements.
2. widespread reputation, especially of a favourable character; renown; public eminence

FAME is a declaration about what we want to create and who we want to become.

FAME is also an acronym:

Ferhan

Ahmed's

Magnificent

Experiences

The word 'magnificent' is exactly the right word.

It means that the experience of every person who walks through our door – patient, referral, visitor, or potential team member – should leave them feeling that something genuinely special happened to them. Not just 'good'. Not just 'professional'. Magnificent.

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That ambition applies equally to the team. The founding philosophy of FAME Dentistry is aligned with the mantra of Simon Sinek when he says, 'your customers will never be any happier than your employees'. Team happiness isn't a nice-to-have. It is the engine of everything we do.

Our Mission

To create a unique environment that attracts growth-orientated people who naturally thrive on providing outstanding customer service and relish the opportunity to figure out what 'magnificent experiences' are – and then be participants in the delivery.

At the heart of FAME Dentistry will be a purpose-built training suite where we develop and deliver world-class technical and soft skills training. We invest in people because we believe that growth is not a perk – it is the point.

If you join this team, you are not just filling a role. You are becoming a participant in an experiment in excellence. You are agreeing to grow, to be challenged, and to hold yourself to a standard that most dental professionals have never encountered.

What We Believe

These are not aspirational statements, to be reads once and then filed away in a desk draw. These are behavioural commitments. They describe how we

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actually behave – with patients, with each other, and with ourselves. They are non-negotiables. They are also not complex. Read them once and you will know whether they resonate. If they do, you are our kind of person.

Our Values

We are all leaders. We step up and step forward at every opportunity. (Rank doesn't determine leadership at FAME – attitude does.)

We radiate happiness. Spontaneous smiling is always #1 on our to-do list. (Not because we are told to. Because at FAME we mean it.)

We communicate meaningfully. We express ourselves with openness and action-inspiring enthusiasm. (We don't dwell on concerns. We don't gossip. We talk directly, clearly, openly and with care.)

We give 'problems' a hug. We embrace challenges for what they are – yet another opportunity to grow. (Problems are not interruptions. They are the signals we use to improve.)

We keep our promises. We do what we say we will do, when we say we will do it. No excuses. (The word of a FAME team member means something.)

We love our work. Being part of our patient's life is a privilege and honour. (We never lose sight of how remarkable it is to be trusted with someone's wellbeing.)

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We are possibility thinkers. We question everything, all the time, in a quest to discover excellence. (Curiosity isn't optional – at FAME it's a job requirement.)

We are uncompromising with our standards. We are proudly passionate about doing things 'our way'. (Good enough is never good enough here.)

We are empathetic cheerleaders. We recognise, value, support and care for each other. (The FAME team is a family – we lift each other up.)

We create magnificent experiences. Every second of every minute, of every day, we think 'Disney'. (Not in a gimmicky way. In the way that Walt Disney himself meant – nothing is accidental, everything is intentional, and of course, the guest always comes first.)

The Patient is Everything

Every patient who sits in one of our chairs has trusted us with something that matters to them. Their health. Their confidence. Their smile. In some cases, their fear.

That trust is sacred. It is the reason we exist. And it has to be felt – not just understood – by every single person on this team, whether you are a clinician, a coordinator, or the person who takes the first call.

The standard we hold ourselves to is this:

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Every patient should leave FAME Dentistry feeling like they were the most important person in the building while they were here. Not one of many. The one.

I've worked in and around dentistry for a long time, and I know the gap between practitioners who feel that way and those who don't. It is visible. It is audible. Patients feel it immediately. I need people around me who feel the way I do – that looking after another human being is an honour. That the skills we have are a blessing we are responsible for using well.

The Standard

The patient is not an interruption to our day. The patient is the reason for our day. Every process, every decision, and every interaction is designed around that single truth.

We will not rush. We will not cut corners. We will not allow a patient to feel like a number on a list. And we will not tolerate team behaviour that makes patients feel anything less than exceptional. That applies whether you are behind a desk, in a surgery, or passing someone in the corridor.

What We Expect

This section is perhaps the most important in this manifesto. It is also the most honest.

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FAME Dentistry will not be the right place for everyone, and we have no interest in being everything to everyone. We are looking for a specific kind of person. Not a particular background, or a particular qualification level, or a particular age. A particular disposition.

You Take Ownership

We want people who look at a problem and ask, 'what can I do about this?' before they ask, 'whose job is this?' We want people who notice what needs doing and just get it done – without being told, without being chased, without being thanked every time.

Discretionary effort – the extra you give that no one asked for – is what separates the exceptional from the adequate. We are building a team of people who give that extra naturally, because they care, not because they are being watched.

You Are Growth-Oriented

We are a team of learners. The world's highest NPS is not achieved by people who think they already know everything. It is achieved by people who are constantly curious, constantly reading, constantly asking how they can do what they do better.

Training and education are not things we do to you, or for you, or even with you. They are things you do for yourself. Your development is your responsibility. We will invest heavily in it – but you have to want it first.

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One of the practices that will shape our culture is a team book club. Reading – particularly books about business, service excellence, and leadership – is something we take seriously. *Unreasonable Hospitality* by Will Guidara will be required reading for everyone on this team. It will give you the lens through which we see everything we do.

You Choose Monday as Much as Friday

If you live for the weekend and endure the working week, FAME Dentistry is not the right environment for you. That's not a criticism – it's just a different kind of person.

We want people who find meaning, energy, and satisfaction in their work. People who look forward to what Monday brings. People who are genuinely energised by helping others, by growing, by being part of something ambitious.

You Hold Yourself to a Standard

We don't want people who meet the bar. We want people who raise it. The standard here is not 'adequate' or 'acceptable' or 'pretty good'. It is magnificent – and if that word makes you uncomfortable or seems over the top, this is probably worth noticing.

Standards are habits. They form over time, through repeated choices. We want people who have already started forming the right habits – in how they look after

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themselves, in how they approach their mornings, in how they treat the people around them.

We Take the Team Seriously

One of the most common ways businesses fail their best people is entirely avoidable.

They hire carelessly, place the wrong people alongside the right ones, and then ask their best performers to absorb the consequences. The drama, the inconsistency, the energy drain of carrying people who were never quite right – all of it lands on the people who care most, because they are the ones least likely to switch off or walk away.

We have no intention of doing that to you.

Building the right team is not something we are leaving to instinct, impression, or the quality of someone's interview performance on a given day. We are approaching it the same way we approach everything at FAME Dentistry – with intention, with rigour, and with a genuine desire to get it right.

The Science of Working Well Together

As part of our recruitment process, every candidate – and every existing team member – will complete a DISC profile.

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DISC is a behavioural assessment that maps how people are wired: how they make decisions, how they communicate, how they respond to pressure, what motivates them, and where friction is most likely to emerge. It is not a measure of intelligence or ability. It is not a pass/fail test. It is a tool for understanding – and at FAME Dentistry, understanding people is something we take seriously.

We use it for three reasons.

The first is self-awareness. Knowing your own profile – your natural strengths, your default responses under stress, the conditions in which you thrive – is some of the most valuable information you can have about yourself. I have spent years building this kind of understanding about who I am and how I operate. I consider it foundational. We want every person on this team to have it too.

The second is compatibility. A great team is not a collection of outstanding individuals. It is a group of people who understand each other well enough to bring out the best in one another. DISC gives us a shared language for that. It allows us to build a team where differences are understood and leveraged rather than misread and resented.

The third is honesty. Most hiring decisions are made on a combination of CV, interview performance, and gut feeling – all of which can be gamed, or simply

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misleading. DISC doesn't replace judgment, but it adds a layer of insight that instinct alone can't provide. We believe our team deserves a recruitment process that is as rigorous about fit as it is about skill.

A Team Without Drama

We are building something specific here. Not just a high-performing team – a harmonious one. A team where people genuinely enjoy working alongside each other. Where the energy in the building is additive, not draining. Where no one is spending emotional bandwidth managing colleagues who should never have been hired.

That environment doesn't happen by accident. It is designed. And the design starts at the point of recruitment.

If you join this team, you will know that the person working alongside you has been through the same process. That they have been chosen with the same care. That the standard applied to them was the same standard applied to you.

That is the promise we are making to everyone who comes through this door.

A Note on Self-Selection

We recognise that not everyone will be comfortable with this level of scrutiny. That is completely understandable, and we mean that genuinely.

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But we would also say this: the people who tend to resist being understood are often the people who already sense the gap between how they present themselves and how they actually operate. If that thought lands with any discomfort, it may be worth thinking through a little.

The people we are looking for tend to react to the idea of a DISC profile with curiosity rather than resistance – because they are already in the habit of examining themselves honestly. They want to know what it reveals. They see self-knowledge not as an exposure but as an advantage.

If that is you, we think you will find the process genuinely interesting. And we will make sure you receive your full results – not just a summary, but a proper debrief – because this is information that belongs to you, and that will serve you long after this conversation.

What You Can Expect from Us

Everything in the previous section is a high standard. We know that. And it would be unfair – and frankly short-sighted – to ask that of people without offering something meaningful in return. Here is our commitment to every person who joins this team.

You Will Grow

FAME Dentistry will have a purpose-built training suite on site. We invest in both technical and soft skills

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development. World-class training is not a benefit we advertise – it is a core part of how this business operates. You will be better at what you do because you worked here.

You Will Be Heard

This is not a top-down organisation. Great ideas are the preserve of the leadership team and they are valued wherever they come from. If you see something that should change, we'd expect you to say so. If you have an idea that could make the experience better for patients or colleagues, we'd expect you to bring it up. We will take it seriously.

You Will Be Part of Something Rare

Most people spend their working lives in organisations that aim for 'good'. FAME Dentistry aims for magnificent and means it. That is genuinely uncommon. The people who join us at the beginning will have had a hand in building something that, in time, may be recognised internationally as a standard for how businesses should treat people. That, I think, is worth something.

You Will Be Valued

We believe that team happiness precedes patient happiness. We will not build a remarkable experience for patients by treating team members as interchangeable.

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You are not a resource. You are a person, and we will treat you accordingly.

Before We Meet Again

We'll be talking again, perhaps several times. We are both making an important decision here. That decision requires reflection and honesty on both parts. Before our next conversation, there are three things we'd like you to do.

One – Read this book.

We'd like you to accept a copy of *Unreasonable Hospitality* by Will Guidara as a gift – not as homework in the conventional sense, but because it is the single best description of the standard we hold ourselves to at FAME Dentistry. It is also, genuinely, one of the most enjoyable books you will read this year.

Will Guidara ran Eleven Madison Park, which became the number one restaurant in the world. This book is about how he got there – not through the food, but through the experience he created around it. Every page has something in it that we think about in the context of what we are building here.

When we next meet, we will ask you about it. Not in a test-like way – we're genuinely curious what landed for you, what surprised you, what you found yourself thinking about afterwards. There is no right answer. But

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there is a revealing one, and we're looking forward to hearing yours.

Two – Recommend a book.

Think about the book that has had the biggest impact on how you think – about work, about yourself, about how you approach the world. It doesn't need to be a business book. It doesn't need to be impressive. It just needs to be honest.

When we meet, we'll ask you to tell us about it. What it changed. Why it stayed with you. What you did differently because of it.

We ask this because it tells us something no CV can. Whether you read. What you're drawn to. Whether you can articulate the effect an idea had on you. These things matter enormously to us.

Three – Consider These Questions.

We're not asking you to write answers down or prepare formal responses. We're asking you to be honest with yourself before we're honest with each other.

- When did you last do something for someone that nobody asked you to do, nobody noticed, and nobody thanked you for?
- Is there a difference between how you behave at your best and how you behave on an average day – and if so, what causes it?

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- When something needs doing and it isn't your job, what's your instinct?
- If the place you currently work adopted our core values tomorrow, would anything change for you?
- What does the first hour of your day look like – and is that a choice or a default?
- When you're in a room with someone who's struggling, what do you feel?

Like I said, the questions are somewhat rhetoric in nature. We probably won't ask you these questions directly when we next meet. But quite possibly through our conversation, the answers will appear.

One Last Thing

The team we are assembling will become the standard that future team members are measured against. The people who join FAME Dentistry at the beginning are not filling roles – they are defining a culture. We take that seriously.

We hope you do too